

Impressive infection

Eugene Kaspersky, CEO Kaspersky Labs, is impressed by the Conficker botnet, thinks it would be a real threat if it were used for things other than money.

**Doodle 4 Google**

12-year-old's doodle was used by Google on its home page

**No illegal downloads**

French govt. passes law to jail offenders after three strikes

would eventually spot him and his web site. This was back in 2007 and Stanton went about furiously popularising his blog in the blogosphere. Eventually, he got loads of traffic and the blogger community was abuzz with excitement and anticipation. Then one day he got his wish fulfilled – Google did hear him. He was called to the Googleplex to present his idea. Relevant papers and non-disclosure agreements were signed and Google heard him out. He became an instant internet hero and began receiving tons of fan mail. For about a year after that only he and Google knew what his idea was. Then in 2008, he revealed his idea on the web site. It was the concept behind booklamp – computerised analysis of the written word. The idea may be pretty meh, but the way Stanton went about attracting attention is brilliant. Maybe all of us armchair ideators can take a cue from this guy. An idea may be worth a million bucks, but to see it to fruition takes perseverance and a lot of ingenuity.

Get ready for the Bhai network

A social network for underworld dons and henchmen would be quite cool, wouldn't it? For friend requests you could send threat requests, trolls would be police and you could be giving ghodas (guns) instead of inane hugs or kisses!

But before getting carried away let us tell you something similar is happening on Facebook right now – as part of a full-fledged ARG. We wrote about ARGs (Alternate Reality Games) a few issues back as the next big thing in the world of interactive gaming. It's where your online life and real world merge and you play the game as yourself, instead of an online avatar. This one called "Supari" is currently in the process of gathering players through Facebook. It's an ambitious endeavour, launched by a witty 30 something duo – Ajesh Shah aka Lambu Kakdi and Tarun Durga aka Chashmish Chaaku. The game is intended to give Mumbaikars a fun thing to do and a chance to mingle with people in real life. So how does it take things from the virtual world into the real world? Well it involves assassinating people with guns. Don't worry, the guns here are water guns! But it's fun nonetheless. What you have to do is join the Supari group on Facebook and follow the link to an external web site where you will have to fill in lots of personal details about yourself such as photo, your work and home addresses and your various phone numbers. You also need to submit a creative answer to why you want to play. Applying doesn't guarantee enrollment. The two godfathers of the game



will first see if you fit the killer's profile. If accepted, you'll have to collect your contract, rules and dog tags from our Supari addas across the city before the game begins. Addresses will be provided shortly. There is a nominal charge of Rs. 50 to cover game expenses. After that, all hell will break loose – you hunt down and assassinate your target with a water pistol or water balloon. The game is three weeks long, 24/7, and is played throughout the city. Exterminate your target and inherit his targets. Become the don by killing off everyone playing the game! The puppetmasters of the game have come up with funny and innovative rules like immunity from from death in Public and Railway Station Loos or if you have a Sunday newspaper with you. Of course, there's no monitoring system so participants are expected to be scrupulous. And yes, it's only for Mumbai. However, if it picks up, we're quite certain other cities and towns will soon start hosting they're own ARGs.

Craigslist's troubles

The US-based classifieds web site has been facing a lot of controversy after South Carolina's attorney general accused it for not having adequately removed "advertisements for prostitution and graphic pornography

material." Looks like moral policing is not just a local affliction. However, the way Craigslist dealt with it is quite interesting. After having replaced

its erotic section with a new adult category and then having company employees go over every new post in the section, the web site filed counter-charges against the attorney general. Besides, the

premise is that a platform cannot be held directly responsible for the kind of content its users generate. Here too, we've had people filing suits against social networks for having content that they find objectionable. Craigslist claims the charges filed by the attorney general of South Carolina are flagrant, citing "In addition to being unwarranted by the facts, legal experts agree that the charges threatened represent an unconstitutional prior restraint on free speech, and are clearly barred by federal law".

On a lighter note, a popular tech blog started a poll to find out "Which is more important to you – Craigslist or South Carolina?". Surprisingly, the results favoured the web site rather than an entire state. 80 per cent of people the people (2278 votes) found that craigslist is more important in the grander scheme of things. The state had probably only one thing on its side – myrtle beach – a rather popular tourist destination. **A**

